STORIES FROM THE QURAN · 1

Nuh and the Great Ark

نوح والسفينة



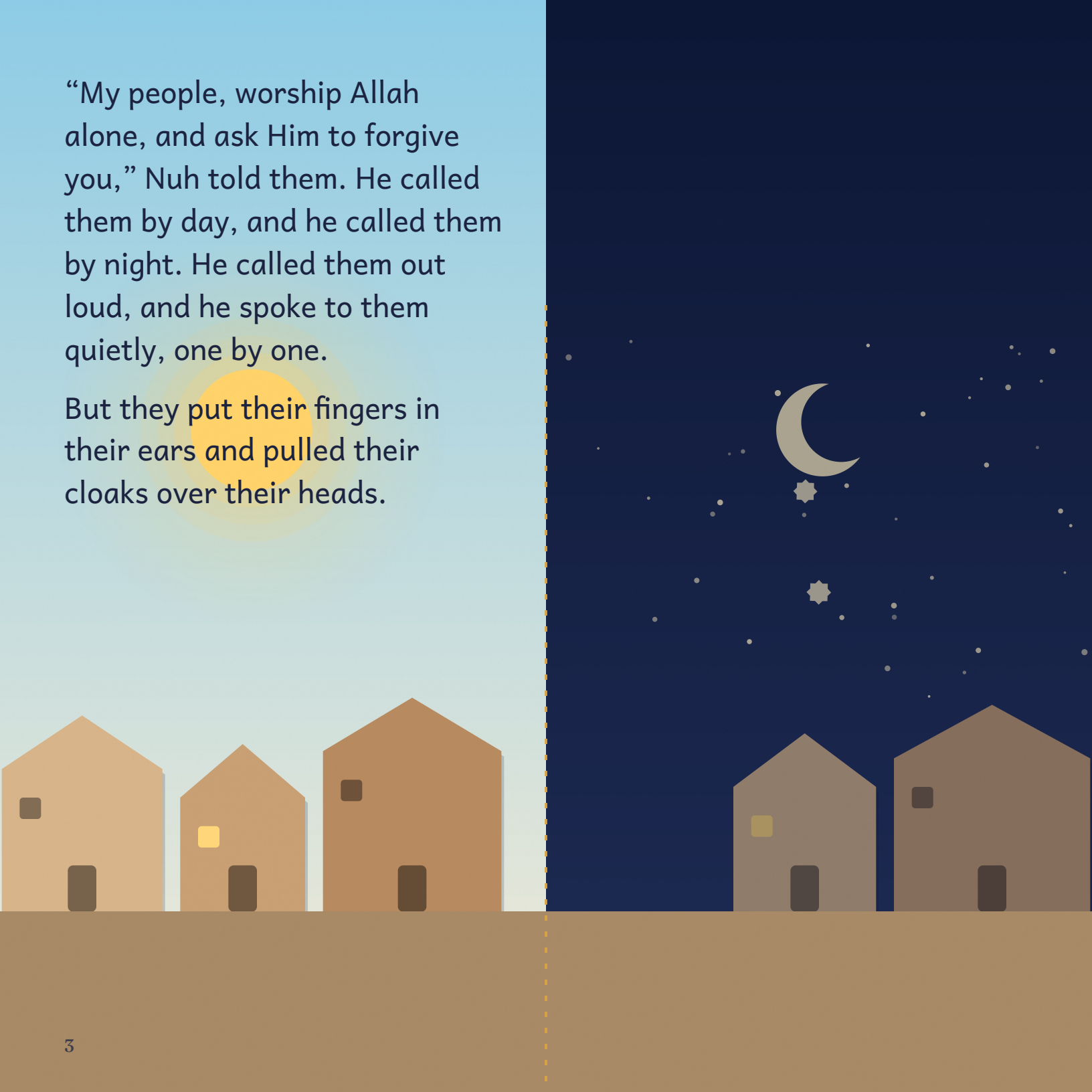
Long, long ago, people forgot Allah. They carved great stones with their own hands, gave them names, and bowed down to them.

So Allah sent them a prophet, a kind and patient man named Nuh (peace be upon him).



“My people, worship Allah alone, and ask Him to forgive you,” Nuh told them. He called them by day, and he called them by night. He called them out loud, and he spoke to them quietly, one by one.

But they put their fingers in their ears and pulled their cloaks over their heads.



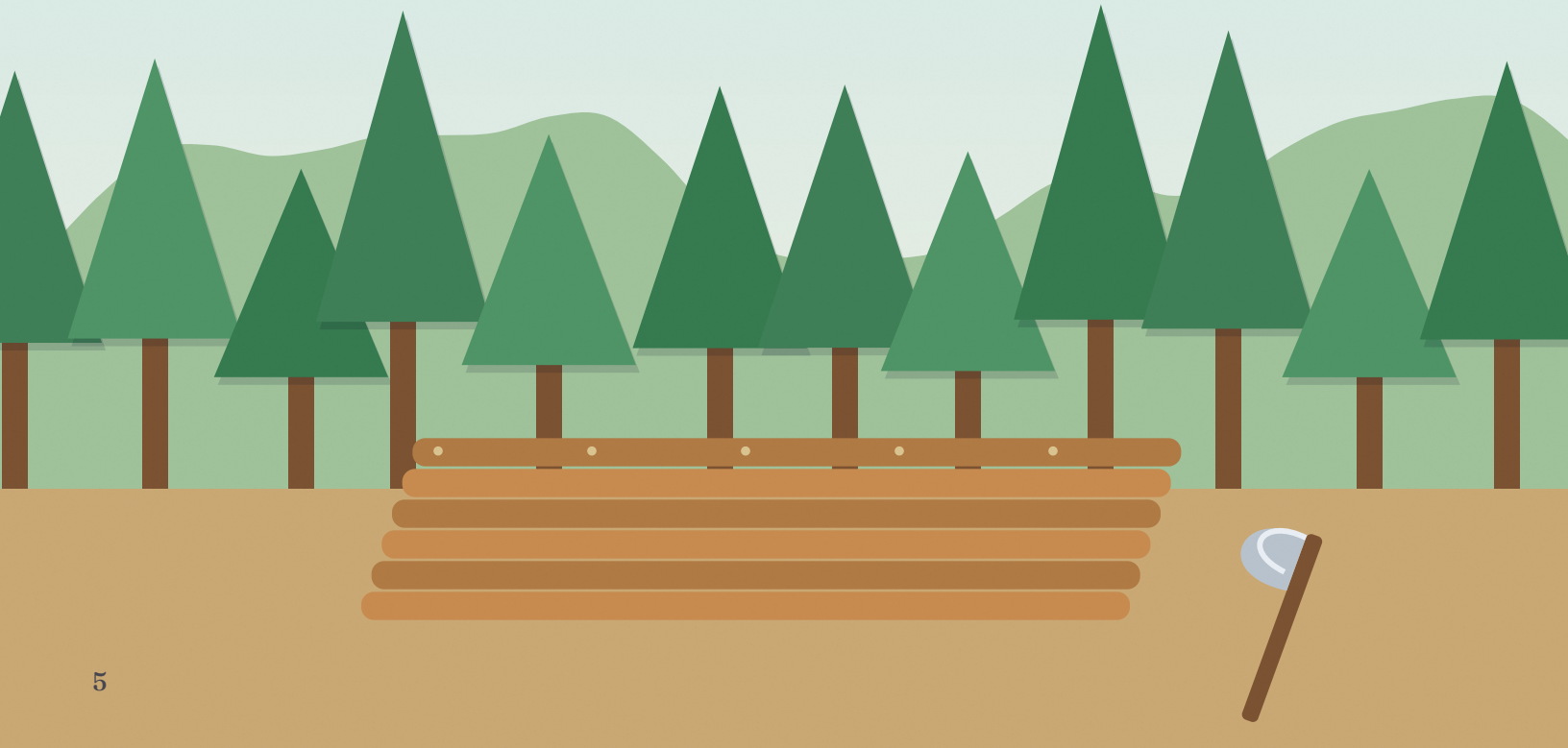
Nuh did not give up. He called his people for nine hundred and fifty years, so long that the stars turned in the sky night after night after night.

But only a few believed.



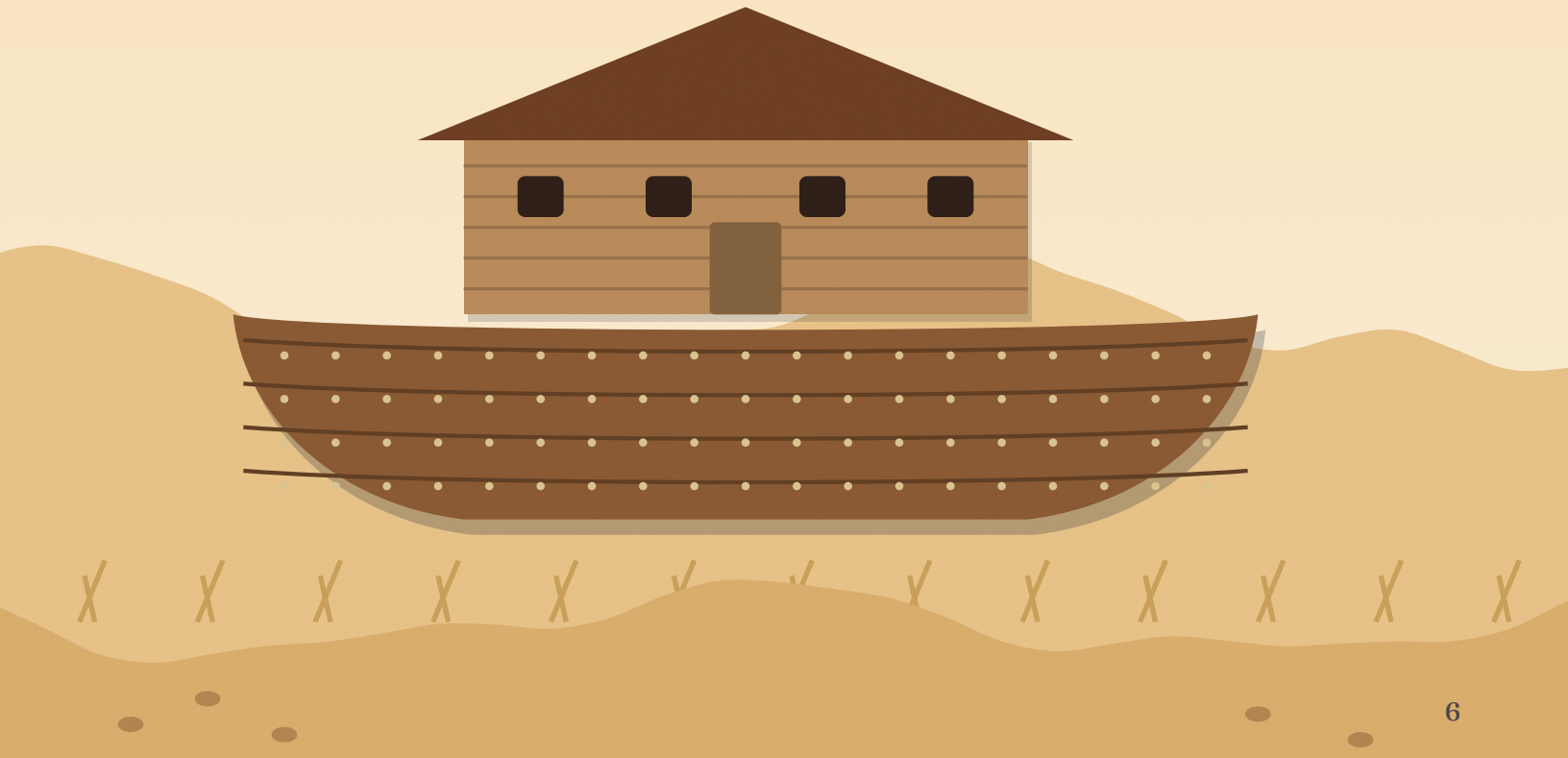
Then Allah told Nuh: “Build the ark, while We watch over you and guide you.”

So Nuh cut wood and shaped planks, one after another, long and strong.



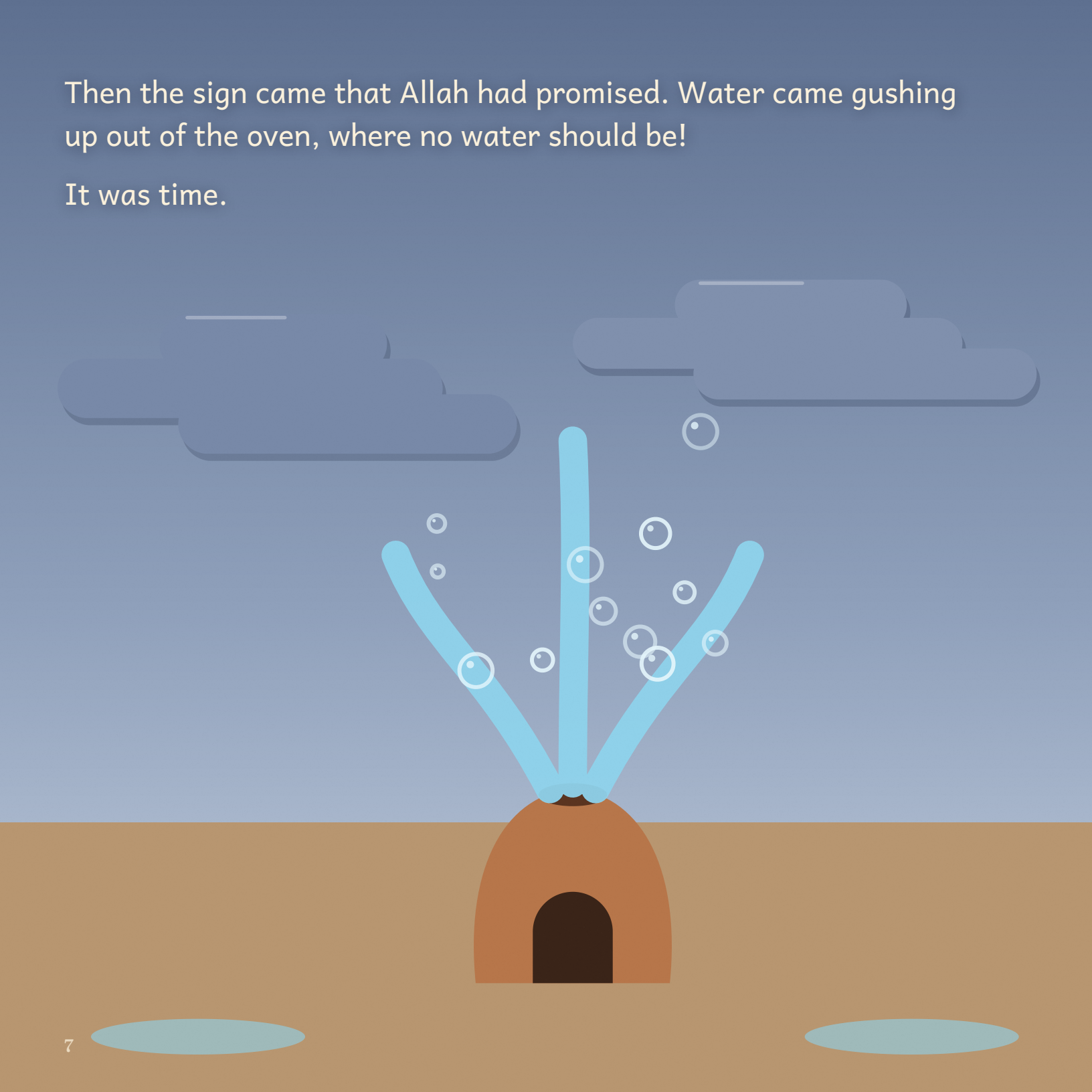
He built the ark far from any sea. Every time the chiefs walked past, they laughed at him. “A ship on dry land!”

Nuh answered calmly: “You laugh at us now. Soon you will know.”



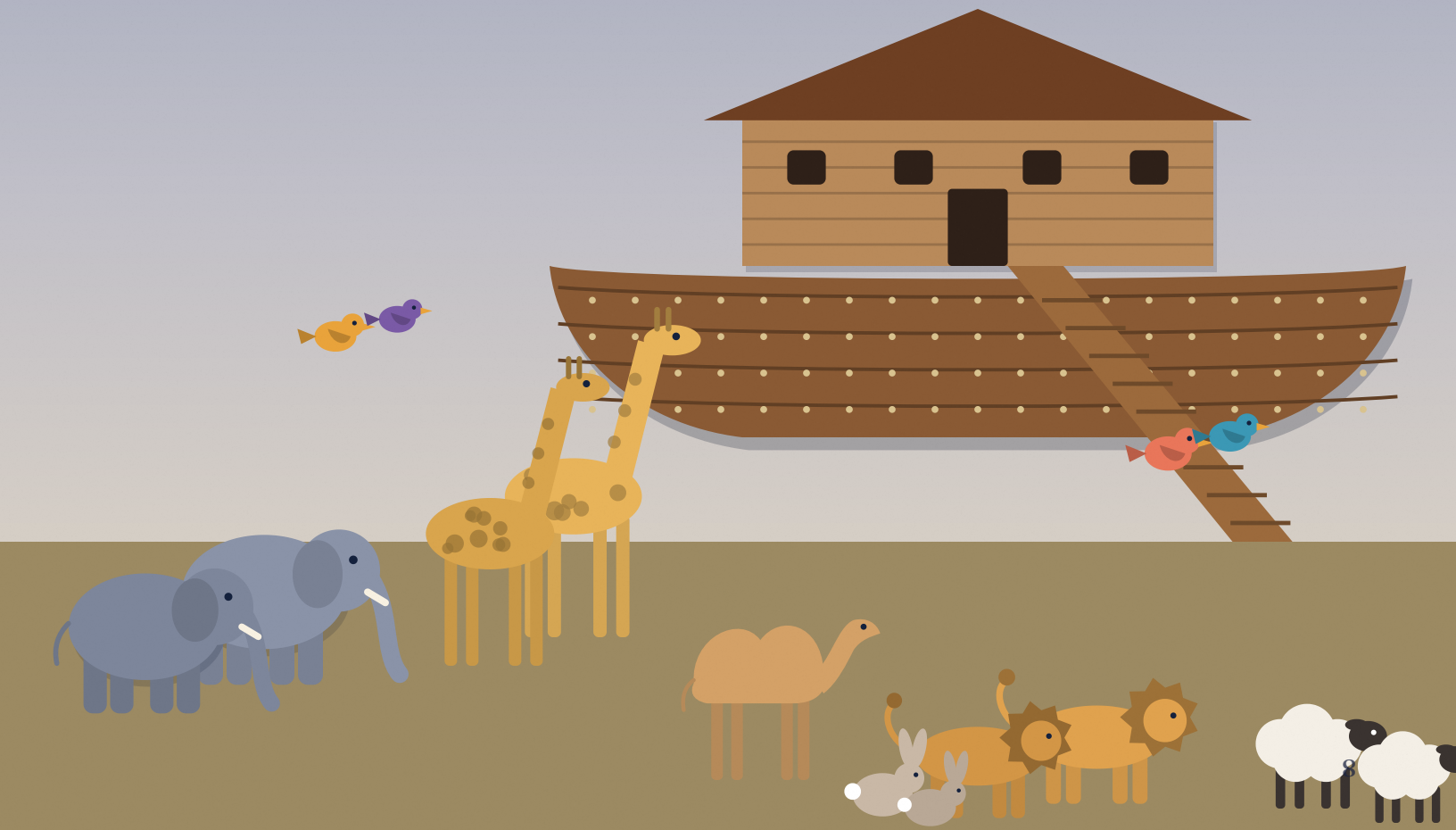
Then the sign came that Allah had promised. Water came gushing up out of the oven, where no water should be!

It was time.



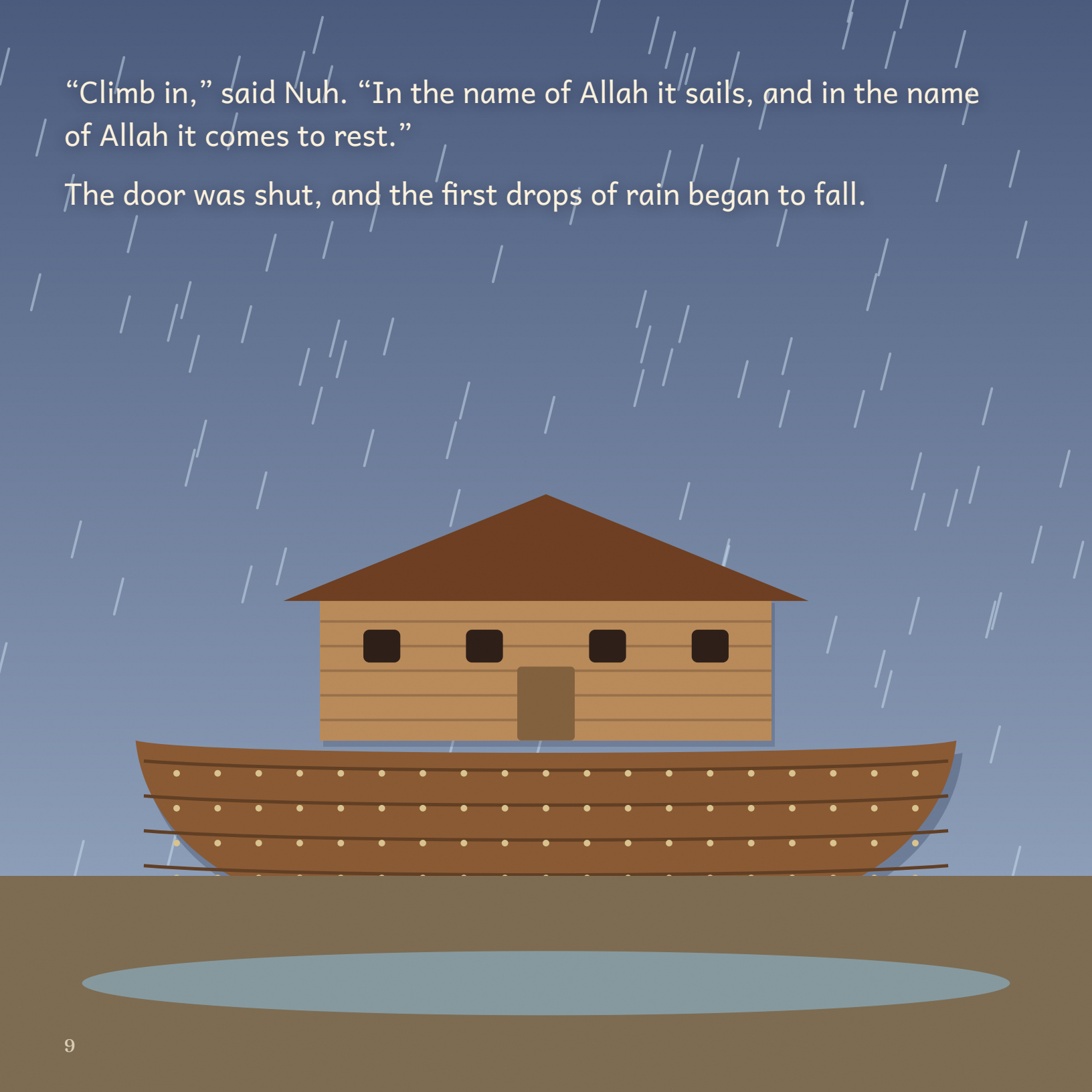
“Carry in the ark two of every kind,” said Allah, “a pair of each, with your family and those who believe.”

Up the ramp they went, two by two: big and small, fast and slow, furry and feathered.



“Climb in,” said Nuh. “In the name of Allah it sails, and in the name of Allah it comes to rest.”

The door was shut, and the first drops of rain began to fall.



Then the sky opened with pouring rain, and the earth burst open with springs. The water from above and the water from below met, just as Allah had planned.



The ark sailed on through waves as high as mountains. Inside, everyone was safe.



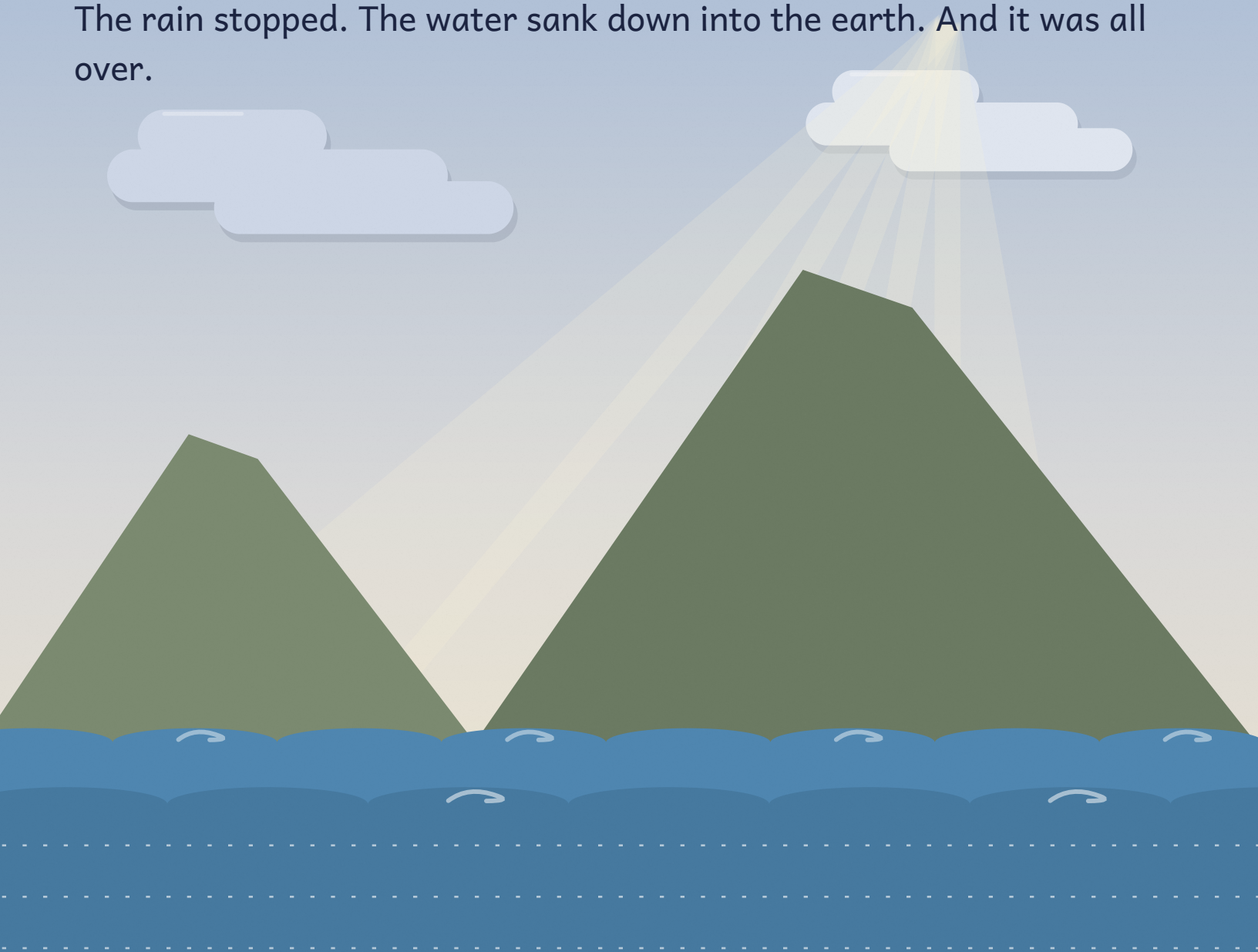
Nuh saw one of his sons standing apart. “My son, come with us!” he called. But his son said, “I will climb a mountain. It will keep me safe.”

“Nothing can keep anyone safe today except Allah’s mercy,” said Nuh. Then a wave came between them.

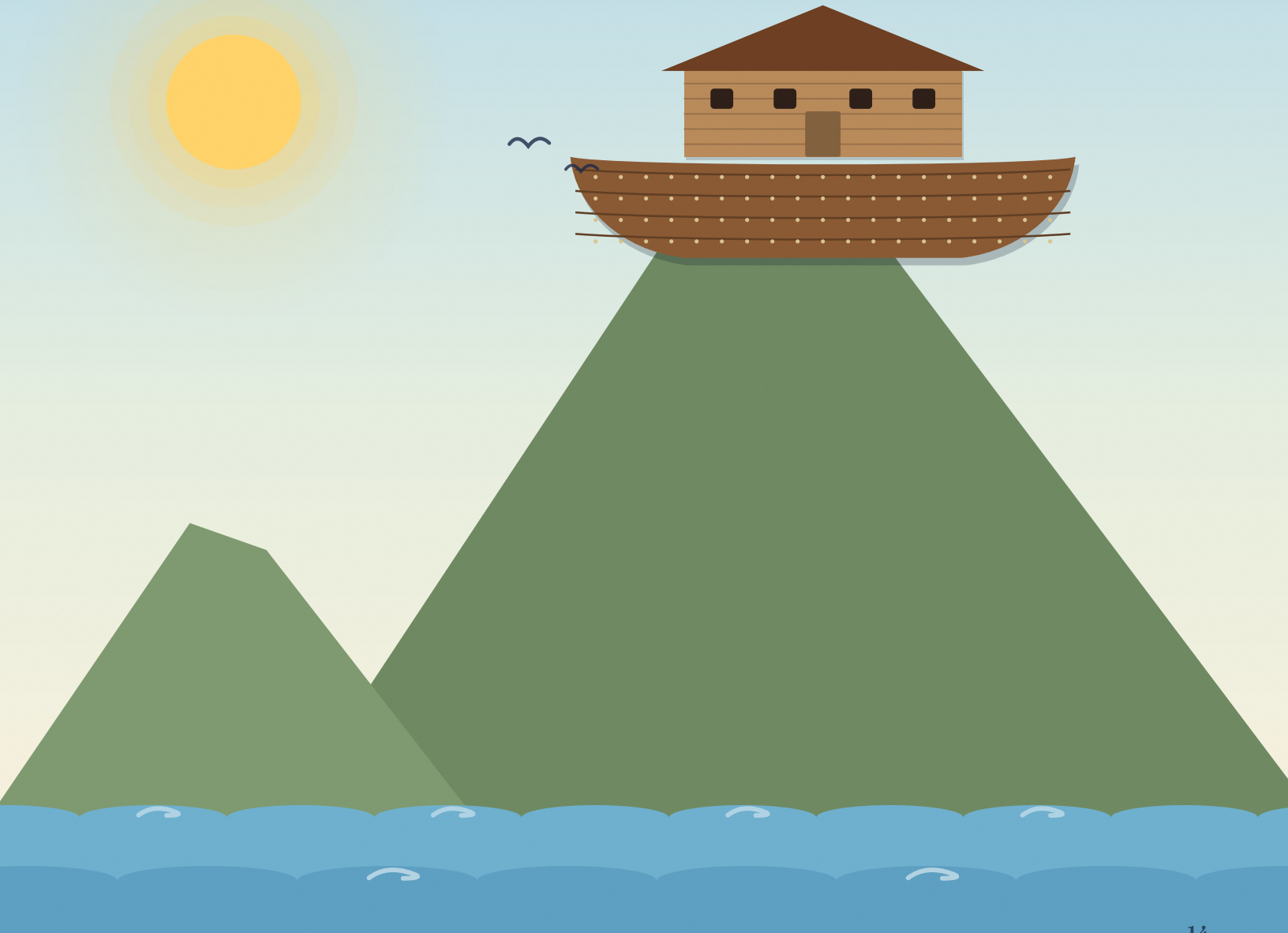


At last Allah said: “O earth, swallow your water! O sky, hold back your rain!”

The rain stopped. The water sank down into the earth. And it was all over.

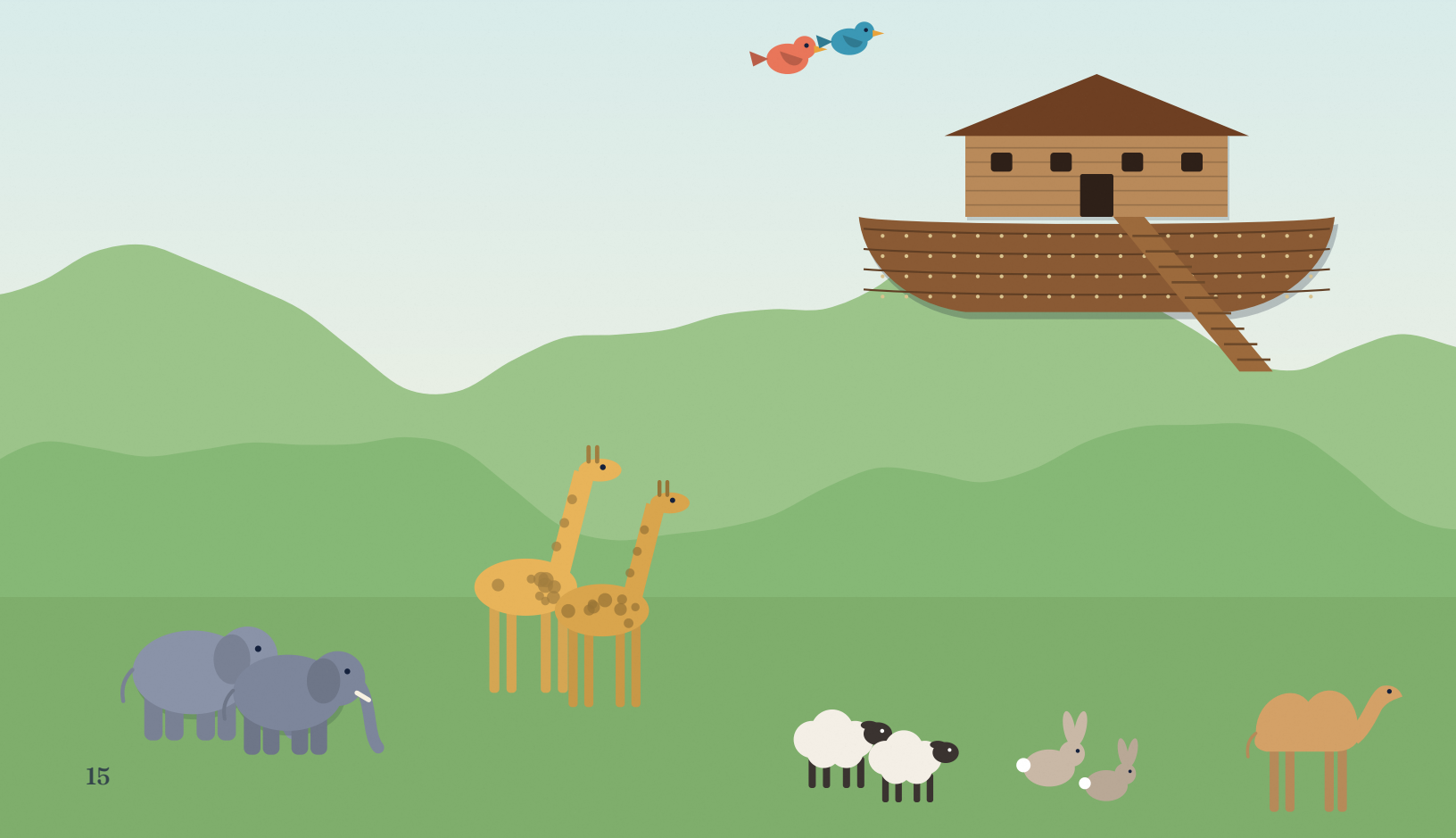


The ark came to rest high on a mountain called Al-Judi. The sun came out, and the air smelled fresh and new.



“Go down in peace from Us,” Allah said to Nuh, “with blessings on you and on those with you.”

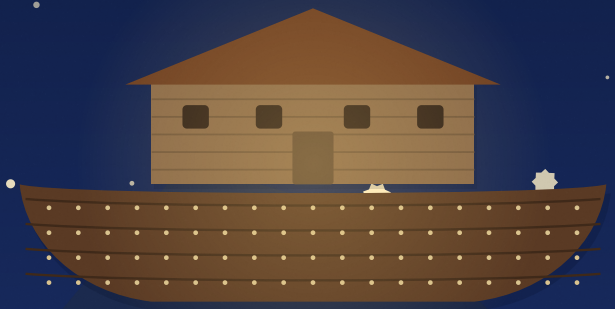
Out they came, two by two, into a washed and shining world.



Grass grew. Flowers opened. Birds sang again. The animals spread across the land, and the people who believed started their lives again.



Nuh thanked Allah and prayed: “My Lord, forgive me and my parents, and everyone who enters my house believing, and all believing men and women.”



Allah saved Nuh and those with him in the laden ship. And He made the ark a sign for all people, to remember forever.



Say Nuh's words

Say them when you climb aboard a boat, a car or a plane.

بِسْمِ ٱللَّهِ

Bismillāh

In the name of Allah

مَجْرٖىٰهَا

majrēhā

it sails

وَمُرْسَىٰهَآ

wa mursāhā

and it comes to rest

From Surah Hud, 11:41

What does the story teach us?



Keep going.
Nuh called his people for 950 years and never gave up.



Do what is right, even if people laugh.
The chiefs laughed at the ark. Nuh kept building.



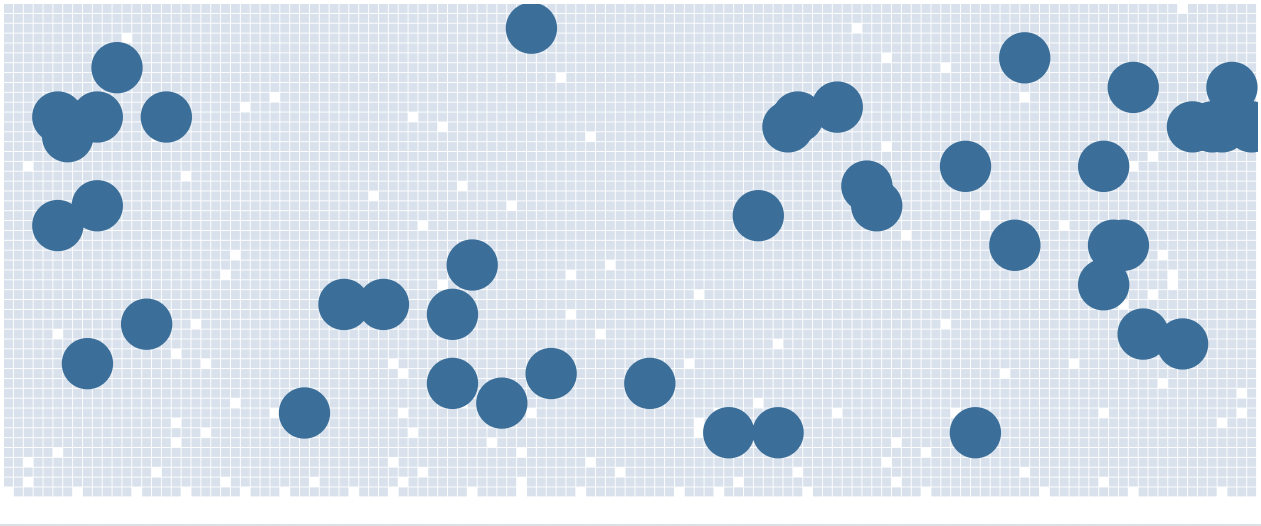
Start with Allah's name.
Say "Bismillah" when you begin something, just like Nuh did.



Allah looks after those who trust Him.
In the biggest storm, the ark was safe.

Did you know?

Nuh's name appears **43** times in the Quran. A whole surah is named after him: **Surah Nuh**, number 71. **Can you count the dots?**



Every verse of the Quran is one tiny square, starting at the top right like a page of the Quran. Each dot is a verse that names Nuh.

He called his people for "a thousand years less fifty": that is how the Quran says 950 (29:14).

Look closer

Some pictures hide a secret from the Quran itself. Go back and find them.

p. 2	Five tall stones. The Quran names five idols of Nuh's people: Wadd, Suwa', Yaghuth, Ya'uq and Nasr (71:23).
p. 3	Half day, half night. Nuh said, "I called my people night and day" (71:5).
p. 4	There are 950 tiny stars in this sky, one for each year Nuh called his people (29:14).
p. 6	Planks and nails. The Quran describes the ark as "planks and nails" (54:13). Count the nails on its side.
p. 7	The oven. In Hud 11:40 and Al-Mu'minun 23:27 the sign was water gushing from an oven, the tannūr.
p. 10	Water from above and water from below meeting (54:11–12).
p. 18	The little fish on the flag. "The laden ship" is how the Quran describes Nuh's ark (26:119), and the very same words describe Yunus's ship (37:140). Find it in book 6.

For parents

Where the story is told. Hud 11:25–49, Al-Mu'minun 23:23–30, Ash-Shu'ara 26:105–122, Al-Qamar 54:9–15, Nuh 71:1–28 and Al-'Ankabut 29:14–15.

Told in simple words. This is a retelling for young children, not a translation. The events follow the verses listed. The pictures add ordinary scene-setting, such as the forest the wood came from. There is no rainbow: it belongs to the Bible's telling, not the Quran's.

The son. The Quran tells of Nuh's son who would not board (11:42–43), and Nuh's plea for him (11:45–46). It is told gently here; your child may want to talk about it.

The pictures. By custom, no prophet is drawn, and in this series no person at all. The pictures show the places, the light and the creatures, so your child can picture the story around them.

Talk about it. Nuh kept going for 950 years. What is something you find hard but keep trying?

Illustrators welcome. These first pictures are a starting point. Artists are invited to redraw any book; the Books page of the Quran Atlas has a brief for every page.

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